

COPPER HUB

// 7 phases • 30 items • check off as you build

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Foundation — Data Structure

START HERE



Set up Google Drive folder architecture

Folders: /Raw Feeds, /Weekly Briefs, /Mine Tracker, /Macro & Demand



Create copper Project on claude.ai

Upload context doc: key mines, your analytical framework, watchlist



Convert daily futures reports to structured format

Standardize fields: date, price, volume, OI, key signals — makes synthesis easier



Define weekly brief template

Sections: macro → supply signals → demand → inventory → technicals → positioning

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Exchange Stockpiles

HIGH
PRIORITY



Set up LME daily inventory tracking

Warrants + cancelled warrants (leading indicator). Free via LME site.

[[FREE — lme.com](#)]



Set up COMEX inventory tracking

Daily CME Group publish. Eligible vs registered stocks — watch the ratio.

[[FREE — cmegroup.com](#)]

☐ Set up SHFE weekly inventory tracking

Published weekly. Seasonal patterns important — watch pre-holiday builds.

[[FREE](#) — [shfe.com.cn](#)]

☐ Build 3-exchange inventory Google Sheet

Combined view with week-over-week delta and rolling 90-day chart

☐ Automate inventory data pull (optional Python script)

Script to scrape/download CSVs on schedule → auto-populate Google Sheet

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Mine Production Tracker

HIGH
PRIORITY

☐ Integrate your junior miner report as structured database

Fields: mine, owner, country, stage, annual output (kt), 2025/2026 forecast, risk flags

☐ Subscribe to ICSG bi-annual supply/demand balance

Underrated free resource. Global mine output + refined production + usage balance.

[[FREE](#) — [icsg.org](#)]

☐ Bookmark Cochilco for Chile production data

Monthly/quarterly Chilean mine output + forward forecasts. Free, in English.

[[FREE](#) — [cochilco.cl](#)]

☐ Set up USGS quarterly minerals data feed

Free global production data. Lags ~2 quarters but useful for baseline.

[[FREE](#) — [usgs.gov](#)]

☐ Build disruption log

Track labor actions, weather, regulatory, and geological events with estimated kt impact

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Refining Capacity & TC/RC

PHASE 2

☐ Track weekly TC/RC spot vs. annual benchmark

Collapse in spot TC/RC = concentrate tightness = bullish signal. Key leading indicator.

[[Fastmarkets](#) / [Metal Bulletin](#)]

☐ Monitor SMM Chinese smelter utilization rates

~45% of global refining. Monthly data on capacity utilization by smelter.

[[SMM](#) — [metal.com](#) (partial free)]

☐ Map top 15 global smelters by capacity

One-time build. Flag any with known expansion, curtailment, or ownership changes.

☐ Track Chinese copper imports/exports monthly

Free from Chinese customs (GACC). Import surge = demand; export = arbitrage window.

[[FREE](#) — [customs.gov.cn](#)]

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Port & Shipment Data

PHASE 2

☐ Subscribe to Kpler or Windward free newsletter/content

Full access is expensive but free content gives directional copper flow signals.

[[FREE tier](#) — [kpler.com](#)]

☐ Track Chinese port copper stocks proxy

SMM publishes bonded warehouse copper stocks in Shanghai — key demand barometer.

[[SMM](#) — partial free]

☐ Monitor major concentrate export port disruptions

Antofagasta, Ilo, Callao (Peru), Walvis Bay — labor/weather disruptions move spot TC/RC

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Demand Forecasts

PHASE 2

☐ Download IEA Critical Minerals reports (annual)

Best free copper demand modeling through 2040. Energy transition scenarios.

[[FREE](#) — [iea.org](#)]

☐ Track Copper Alliance end-use demand breakdowns

Construction, electronics, transport, industrial — useful for sector-level demand shifts.

[[FREE](#) — [copperalliance.org](#)]

☐ **Build real-time demand proxy composite**

Track: China grid investment + EV sales (monthly) + NBS PMI construction sub-index
[[FREE](#) data sources]

☐ **Quarterly refresh from BNEF or CRU public summaries**

Even free/public excerpts provide directional forecast changes worth tracking.
[[BNEF](#) / [CRU](#) (partial free)]

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Synthesis & Delivery

ONGOING

☐ **Publish first weekly copper brief**

Even with partial data. Ship it, iterate. The habit matters more than completeness.

☐ **Build master dashboard (single-page weekly snapshot)**

Inventory levels (3 exchanges) + TC/RC + disruption flag + demand signal + technical setup

☐ **Establish source log / data quality audit habit**

Simple running doc: what you ingested, from where, any data quality issues flagged

☐ **Quarterly hub review — prune, update, improve**

What sources are you actually using? What's missing? What's noisy?